If You Have to Ask

By Gabriel Green; Marvin Hodges, Em Allison and Saidu Tejan-Thomas

Ask a Black Dude

Have you ever had a question you wanted to ask that one black person you know,

But refrained because you didn't want to run the risk of sounding racist?

Ever wish there was just a one-stop shop for all things black?

Think about it, access to your very own single authority and spokesperson for an entire race of people.

Well, son-of-a-gun, you're in luck because today, for a limited time only, you have access to your friendly neighborhood ask a black dude;

INTRODUCTION

Ever had a white friend, acquaintance or even complete stranger ask you a question that was SO past offensive that you couldn't even think of a rude enough answer? Gabriel Green is here to help with his comical yet insightful piece, "Ask a Black Dude," that aims to addresses some of the most common questions that we, as black people, are asked. And if that's not quite enough, Marvin Hodges, Em Allison and Saidu Tejan-Thomas take it one step further and explain "Da Rules" for black people in America today.

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Ask a Black Dude: A mail-in encyclopedia complete with answers to questions that'll boggle the minds of white people for centuries.

Let's give it a try, shall we?

Question: Why are black people so good at basketball?

Answer: We're not.

There isn't some magical chromosome in Lebron James' DNA that makes him genetically prone to run faster or jump higher than everyone else,

But just think, if everything around you stated that your best alternative was either jail or the cemetery, you'd be shooting a thousand jumpers a day too.

Next question.

Umm, do black people hate **ALL** white people?

Of course, we don't.

We just hate people who perpetuate or refuse to acknowledge the history of social, cultural, political, and racial ****** placed against us;

R EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

That their white is pure coincidence.

Next question.

Why are black women so angry?

This has multiple answers.

They are a queen in a land where men take turns ***** on her throne,

Her body is the subject you left in private but never worth your love and respect in public,

Or 3, she will raise her sons to become young tombstones or men who will call her b**** with the same mouth they used to feed from her nurturing bosoms;

Pick one.

Next question.

Uh, why don't black people trust the government?

Let's put this in terms you can understand.

So . . . remember that classic Charlie Brown bit where Lucy wanted to get Charlie to kick the football but Charlie didn't want to, because he knew that as soon as he would try, Lucy would pull the ball away only for Charlie to hurt himself,

But somehow, Lucy convinced him anyway only for Charlie to meet his identical fate.

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Guess which one is Lucy.

Next question.

Is it . . . is it racist . . . is it racist if I . . .

Yes. Next question

Um, why can't white people use the 'N-word'?

What, '***neighbor***'?

Of course, you can use it.

It's an endearing term commonly used in phrases like:

"What's good, my neighbor?"

Or, "Man, that neighbor's crazy."

Or my personal favorite, "****, I wish a neighbor would."

This product is satisfaction guaranteed.

You'll understand black culture in just 30 days.

Your friends will envy at your new-found liberal, social consciousness.

Call today and receive a free bonus gift of a black fist afro pick and a 'Can't take off' scarf.

You'll be down with the struggle in no time.

Call while supplies last.

Disclaimer: The views, opinions, and answers given by this one African American . . . black person is not a direct

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reflection of black people everywhere.

Results may vary.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Gabriel Green
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Da Rules

Be accommodating

Smile

Be polite

Slouch a little when they see you.

Confidence scares them.

Be gentle,

Eyes low

No sudden movements

Don't have objects like squares and rectangles in your

pockets

Don't reach for your wallet

Why did you run?

You got something to hide?

Keep that rap music low,

You may be shot for it

Be seen and not heard.

Do not fit the description

Your hair announces your presence

It is loud just like you

keep it tamed and hushed down.

Let them touch it [hair] when they ask

Get relaxers

You wear your hair straight

So why can't ***they*** get braids, dreads, afros

Do not cry.

Do not break rules,

Do not have accidents

Or get in arguments

Wear bright clothing

Let the other guy have the stronger handshake

Do not tell white friends you're on scholarship

Do not watch Roots

Stay away from ancestry.com

You won't find what you're looking for

Be regular

Be good
Cross to the other side of the street so they
don't have to
Do not smoke
Do not drink
Do not have sex,
We have enough of you
Do not throw up sideways peace signs
it looks too much like a gang sign
You are a gang sign
Don't be a statistic
Don't be a baby daddy
Do not date outside your race
Your own people will consider you a sell out
anyway
"What, you not strong enough to handle a black
woman?"
Do not build empires
Do not build things exclusively for the betterment of your
race
That's reverse racism

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Do you hear me boy?
Speak when I'm talking to you son
Speak when you pass them on the street
Do not pass "Go"
Do not collect $200
Go straight to jail
Do not express yourself
or walk around Wal-Mart with a Wal-Mart gun
Do not wear hoodies
Or walk in white neighborhoods in
Texas, Arizona, Florida
Bite the bullet
Why are you shooting yourself?
Why are you shooting yourself?
Why are you people always shooting yourselves?
In the chest, while handcuffed.
Do not raise your hand in class
You'll just be another negro without answers
Light skins be proud
that you are comfortable black
your ambiguity so interesting

Wait!

But my melanin has meaning

It is profound

Dark skin so greedy

It gobbles up nouns

thoughts so tangled

Look what it did to my hair.

Reaching to the sky at all angles

Praying that you don't shoot

I've always been black.

But I didn't always know it.

I guess it's because I didn't-

Have a thinner nose

Have smaller lips

Be lighter

Be Wayne Brady

White people love Wayne Brady he makes Bryant

Gumbel look like Malcolm X

Do not quote Malcolm X

Do not read for fun

Do not own a gun

Let your non-black friends say "nigga"

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Pretend it doesn't bother you

If ***their*** women fear for ***their*** lives, that's great

If ***their*** women fear for the lives of ***their*** children even

better

Be small.

Your dark frame casts a very large shadow

Do not be 6'4 292 pounds

Kinky follicles curled into grenades

Don't you know that black bodies are weapons?

Don't you know ***they*** have weapons?

SOURCE INFORMATION

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View the performance of this poem in 3 voices here:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xpvutGPY7zU